Scope & Lens

Our free guide

Winning new business in *the age of slop.*

Everyone can make the thing now. So what are clients actually buying, and how do you become the agency they already know when the brief lands?

What changed

Everyone can *make the thing* now.

A team of three can generate in an afternoon what used to take a department a fortnight. It will be on brief, nicely art directed and **completely forgettable**. When competence is universal, competence stops being a reason to hire anybody.

1

Being findable stopped working

At fifty credible agencies, being one of them meant something. At five hundred, the client cannot tell you apart before they meet you.

2

Pitches got more expensive

More of them, less qualified, lower win rates. The maths stopped working for most agencies years ago.

3

Clients got more frightened

The easier work is to make, the harder a choice is to defend. They are buying a reason they can repeat.

> **If your client had to explain to their CEO, without you in the room, why they chose you, *could they do it in one sentence?***
>
> If not, the pitch is not won, whatever the feedback said.

What works instead

Permissionless value.

Giving a prospect something genuinely useful **before** you have any right to their attention: before a brief, before a relationship, with no promise of return. It proves the thing that is now scarce, which is that you saw something nobody else saw. And it arrives before the competitive set exists, when you are the only agency in the conversation.

The short version **Competence is everywhere now, so prove perception. Be useful before the brief, keep being useful, and you are the only agency in the room.**

Why it matters

Most buyers are *not buying*. Yet.

95%

of B2B buyers are out of market at any one time.

17%

of agencies run outbound and inbound properly. Most rely on referrals.

63%

remembered the stories in a pitch. Only 5% remembered a statistic.

65%

60,000x faster

of people are visual learners. Images land faster than text.

Sources: 95%, LinkedIn B2B Institute & Ehrenberg-Bass. 17%, Productive agency survey, 2023. 63%, Heath & Heath, Made to Stick.

How it works

Three pillars, *in this order.*

Permissionless Prospecting

Creates the opportunity before a brief exists, by spotting the trigger and leading with value.

Strategic Storytelling

Makes it winnable, with an idea the client can repeat without you in the room.

Visualised Value

Makes the thinking impossible to ignore, because it is understood at a glance.

In practice

Three and a half *hours a week.*

Monday · 30 min	Scan your named list for triggers: people moves, funding, launches, results.
Tuesday · 60 min	Pick one account. Research the business problem behind the brand.
Wednesday · 90 min	Build one page. One chart, one observation. Right, not beautiful.
Thursday · 15 min	Send it to one named person. No credentials, no ask.
Friday · 20 min	Log it, plan the next useful touch, and park anything that is not moving.

One account a week is fifty a year. Keep showing up for them and the pipeline takes care of itself.

Free, and no email wall

Where are *your* gaps?

Permissionless Healthcheck →
Your score and the three fixes that move it fastest.

Who should I target? →
A short list of organisations that fit you, and who to approach.

How can I be permissionless? →
What to send them, and what to say.